

Fairfield Civic Research Tool

AI Transparency Constitution
Version 1.0 · February 17, 2026

The Fairfield Civic Research Tool is designed to serve our community by providing transparent, accountable, and ethical AI-powered research capabilities. This constitution outlines our principles, data sources, AI instructions, and operational commitments to ensure responsible civic technology deployment.

In light of ongoing developments in AI safety and governance, we believe complete transparency is not optional — it is essential for maintaining public trust in civic AI applications.

DATA SOURCES & CONTENT

Our AI system searches only official Fairfield city documents that have been explicitly loaded by authorized developers. No external data sources, private information, or non-public documents are included.

Document Type	Source	Status
City Council Transcripts	YouTube archived meetings	■ Public
City Ordinances	Official city website	■ Public
Planning Documents	City planning department	■ Public

What We Do NOT Include:

- Private citizen information or communications
- Confidential city business or executive sessions
- External databases or third-party sources
- Social media content or public comments
- Any document not explicitly approved by city government

AI SYSTEM INSTRUCTIONS

Our AI system (Claude by Anthropic) operates under strict instructions designed to ensure accuracy, neutrality, and appropriate civic discourse:

- Cite all information with specific document sources and dates
- Present balanced information without political bias or advocacy
- Clearly distinguish between factual reporting and interpretation
- Acknowledge uncertainty when information is incomplete or unclear
- Refuse to answer questions about private individuals or confidential matters

Technical Safeguards:

- RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) system limits responses to loaded documents only
 - Vector database search ensures relevance scoring and source traceability
 - All responses include source document identification and relevance scores
 - No external internet access during response generation
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OPERATIONAL PRINCIPLES

Data Governance:

- Document loading requires authorization from City Council Member Bob Ferguson or designated partner
- All source documents must be publicly available city records
- Document inventory is updated and published with each addition
- Citizens may request specific documents be added or removed

Quality Assurance:

- Regular testing of search functionality and response accuracy
 - Public feedback mechanism for reporting errors or concerns
 - Periodic review of AI responses for bias or inaccuracies
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LIMITATIONS & RISK MITIGATION

Known Limitations:

- AI systems can misinterpret context or nuance in documents
- Responses are only as accurate as the source documents provided
- Cannot provide legal advice or official city interpretations
- May not capture the most recent city decisions or changes

Risk Mitigation Strategies:

- Clear disclaimers about AI limitations on every response
 - Direct links to source documents for verification
 - Contact information for city staff when AI cannot provide adequate answers
 - Regular updates to document database as new information becomes available
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ACCOUNTABILITY & CONTACT

This tool is developed and maintained by City Council Member Bob Ferguson in collaboration with AI research expertise. We welcome questions, concerns, and suggestions for improvement.

Developer Commitment: We commit to maintaining this transparency document, updating it as the system evolves, and responding to community feedback about AI governance and safety.

Contact: City Council Member Bob Ferguson

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	2/17/2026	Initial AI transparency constitution created

This constitution will be publicly available and updated as our AI system evolves.
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